to Anahilavada-pattana in northern Gujarat (map, p. xv).[78] This was the capital of the mighty Chaulukyas, a ruling house that was paramount throughout northwestern India's coastal and inland regions – mapping onto the modern Indian states of Gujarat and southern Rajasthan – between the later tenth through early fourteenth centuries. According to Juzjani, the Chaulukya forces under either Mularaja II (r. 1176–1178) or his young successor Bhimadeva II (r. 1178–1242) repelled Mu'izz al-Din's attack, again in part with the use of war elephants.[79]

Evidently learning from this reverse, Mu'izz al-Din and his forces subsequently operated within shorter eastward *radii*. They conducted a successful campaign to Peshawar in AH 575/1179–1180 CE. But, after a show of force against the Ghaznavid sultan Khusrau Malik at Lahore in AH 577/1181 CE – the first of three such campaigns, as described below – Mu'izz al-Din again widened his circuit: in AH 578/1182 CE he marched to the Indus's *débouchement* at Dibul – now generally thought to be the archaeological site of Banbhore[80] – in southwestern Sindh, "captur[ing] the whole of that seaside country and, taking much wealth, he ordered return [to Ghazna]."[81] It is possible that, in lieu of possessing a maritime port in Gujarat, the Shansabani sultan aimed for neighboring Sindh: during the twelfth century, the famed Dibul was still a major riverine emporium on the Indus, serving as a crucial link between the Indian Ocean world and the overland routes upriver – important enough, in fact, to be preceded by at least one fortified bastion as the first line of defense from the Indus's sea access (see esp. Chapter 6).

Thereafter, it would appear that the status of the last Yamini–Ghaznavids required a final resolution. For all future incursions into the north Indian plains, unfettered possession of the important city of Lahore was necessary, given its pivotal location in the center of the Panjab and in practically a straight line between Ghazna and the heart of the Ganga–Yamuna *duab*.[82] This meant the eradication of any lingering Ghaznavid loyalties in the region. Thus, Mu'izz al-Din's second campaign to the Panjab in AH 581/1185 CE left destruction in its path around Lahore, and the posting of a loyal deputy at nearby Sialkot signaled the gradual cornering of the Ghaznavids within their last stronghold.[83]

It is unsurprising that, in response to this obvious aggression, Khusrau Malik mobilized his own forces to besiege Sialkot, forces that included contingents of Kukhar tribesmen.[84] Failure to capture the fort – and thus no reward for their trouble – led the Kukhars to desert Khusrau Malik. Largely defenseless, the last Ghaznavid ruler was finally captured by Mu'izz al-Din the following year (AH 582/1186 CE) and brought back to Ghazna. As if yet another trophy of the momentous Shansabani triumph over the Yamini–Ghaznavid house, Khusrau Malik was sent to Sultan Ghiyath al-Din at Firuzkuh, where the *minar* commemorating the capture of Ghazna already towered over the heart of the Firuzkuh